

Samudra Manthan Scheme (National Offshore Exploration Scheme)



Source: PIB

Recently, the Union Cabinet approved '**Samudra Manthan**'—the **National Offshore Exploration Scheme**, translating the **Prime Minister's Independence Day 2025 vision** of unlocking India's offshore energy potential.

- **About:** It is a **Central Sector Scheme of the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas** with an approved outlay of **₹84,084 crore for implementation up to FY 2030-31**, focusing on deepwater, ultra-deepwater and frontier offshore hydrocarbon exploration.
- **Need:** Offshore exploration is **highly risky, capital-intensive and technologically complex, with a gestation period** of five to ten years. A single deepwater exploratory well may cost **\$125-150 million**, while existing oil and gas fields are witnessing an **annual natural production decline of about 6-7%**.
- **Objective:** The scheme aims to **de-risk offshore exploration, attract private investment, accelerate domestic oil and gas production, reduce import dependence, strengthen energy security** and advance the goals of **Viksit Bharat, Make in India** and **Atmanirbhar Bharat**.
- **Features:** It provides for the **acquisition, processing and interpretation of seismic data**, along with a **ccelerated deepwater, ultra-deepwater and scientific drilling** in frontier offshore basins.
- **Infrastructure:** It includes **common offshore production and evacuation infrastructure, an integrated Oil and Gas Manufacturing and Services Zone**, digital programme management, capacity building, technology adoption, stakeholder engagement and international cooperation.
- **Financial Allocation:** Of the total outlay, ₹43,200 crore is allocated for drilling 60 deepwater exploratory wells, **₹28,534 crore for seismic data acquisition, ₹10,000 crore for common offshore infrastructure hubs and ₹2,000 crore for oil and gas manufacturing** and services zones.
- **Implementation and Risk Sharing:** The government will support up to **50% of the eligible drilling cost, subject to a maximum of ₹675 crore per well**, to reduce exploration risks and encourage sustained public and private investment in offshore basins such as **Krishna-Godavari, Cauvery, Mahanadi and the Andaman region**.
- **Current Progress:** ONGC plans to drill 150 deepwater wells over seven years and assess nearly **5,600 Million Metric Tonnes of Oil Equivalent (MMTOE)** of potential resources, while Oil India is exploring the Andaman region and has reported natural gas in **Vijayapuram-2 and Vijayapuram-3**.
- **Production and Reserve Targets:** Subject to successful exploration, the scheme seeks to add over 600 MMTOE of reserves, raise annual domestic oil and gas production from about 62 MMTOE to 80 MMTOE and expand the resource base from **1.6 billion to 2.2 billion tonnes of oil equivalent**.

- **Significance:** The scheme could **reduce crude oil imports by nearly ₹1 lakh crore annually**, generate large-scale employment, strengthen indigenous manufacturing and develop a globally competitive offshore technology and services ecosystem.

Read More: [Samudrayaan Project](#)